

# **Guidelines for Prevention of Misleading Advertisement in Coaching Sector, 2024 - Compiled Summary**

*COMPILED SUMMARY - NOT THE OFFICIAL VERBATIM TEXT. This document is a summary compiled from the Central Consumer Protection Authority's official notification announcement, Press Information Bureau releases, and corroborating legal commentary. It is not, and does not replace, the Gazette notification. For binding wording, consult the official Gazette of India notification dated 13 November 2024. Compiled September 2026.*

- 1. Issuing authority and status.** Issued by the Central Consumer Protection Authority (CCPA) under the Consumer Protection Act, 2019. Notified and in effect from 13 November 2024.
- 2. Who these Guidelines apply to.** Any person who provides coaching, or establishes, runs, or administers a coaching centre - of any kind, including exam-preparation, tuition, and skill-training coaching - and any endorser of such coaching, across all forms of advertisement.
- 3. Core prohibition.** Coaching providers must not make false or misleading claims, or engage in unfair trade practices, in advertising their services. Representations must be accurate, clear, and must not conceal material information a prospective student would need to make an informed decision.
- 4. Specific practices treated as misleading.** False or unsubstantiated claims about: selection numbers, ranks, or exam results achieved by past students; guaranteed selection, job security, or "100% success"; salary or placement guarantees; and false urgency or scarcity claims (e.g. seats or offers about to close) used to pressure enrolment.
- 5. Mandatory disclosures when citing a student's result.** An advertisement that cites a student's name, photograph, rank, or result must also disclose: the specific course or programme the student was enrolled in; whether it was a paid or free course; and whether the student completed the full course or only part of it (e.g. a crash course, test series, or mock-test-only enrolment).
- 6. Consent requirement.** Written consent must be obtained from the student (or, where applicable, their guardian) before using the student's name, photograph, or testimonial in any advertisement.
- 7. Disclaimers.** Any disclaimer qualifying a claim must be displayed prominently, in a font size and manner at least as noticeable as the claim it qualifies - a disclaimer in fine print does not satisfy the Guidelines.
- 8. What the Guidelines are aimed at, per CCPA enforcement to date.** Public CCPA enforcement action reported through Press Information Bureau releases has centred on: false claims of "top rank" or "top score" results; advertisements omitting that a cited student took only a short/free program; admissions cancelled without a full refund of fees; and deficiency of service against the fees charged. The CCPA has issued show-cause notices and imposed monetary penalties on coaching institutes under this framework (reported cumulative penalties in the tens of lakhs of rupees as of the sources reviewed) - figures change as enforcement continues; do not treat any specific amount here as current without checking a live CCPA/PIB source.
- 9. Enforcement mechanism.** As with the Greenwashing Guidelines, this instrument does not set its own penalty scale - enforcement is through the Central Consumer Protection Authority's powers under the Consumer Protection Act, 2019 (false/misleading advertisement, unfair trade

**practice). A student or parent with an individual grievance (e.g. non-refund of fees, misrepresented faculty or facilities) can also pursue a consumer complaint under the Consumer Protection Act, 2019 before a District/State Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission, independent of any CCPA enforcement action.**

Sources relied on for this summary: Press Information Bureau release PRID 2073013 (Guidelines prevent coaching centers from making false claims); Press Information Bureau release PRID 2122361 (CCPA advises coaching centres to comply; enforcement update); Ministry of Consumer Affairs notification announcement, 13 November 2024.